

Tech Career Study Plan

B.Tech CSE Graduate · GATE + Software Jobs + Govt Jobs · 10 AM – 7 PM Daily

Your 3 Goals

GATE (IIT/NIT MTech)	Software Job (NQT / Off-campus)	Govt Job (DRDO / ISRO / SSC)
Score 35–45 to qualify at NIT with SC category. GATE 2025 score: 19 — needs structured coverage of OS, DBMS, TOC, Algorithms, CN.	Clear aptitude + DSA coding rounds (NQT-style). Build portfolio projects. SC category cutoffs are lower in many companies.	Aptitude + reasoning is the key gate. Consistent daily practice over 3–6 months builds the speed needed to clear these exams.

Key Insight: GATE subjects (OS, DBMS, Algorithms) overlap heavily with software job interviews and govt exam syllabi. Every hour of GATE study multiplies across all 3 goals simultaneously.

GATE

DSA / Coding

Aptitude

Project

Break / Review

Day A — GATE Core + Aptitude

Focus: Deep GATE study + Aptitude practice + 1.5 hrs DSA to keep coding sharp

10:00 – 10:15	Warm-up Review Review Revise yesterday's notes — 15 min only, no new topics
10:15 – 12:15	GATE Core — Deep Study GATE OS → DBMS → Algorithms → TOC → CN (rotate weekly). Read concept + solve PYQs.
12:15 – 1:00	Lunch + Real Break Break Step away from screen completely. No studying.
1:00 – 2:30	GATE — Practice & PYQs GATE Solve 20–25 previous year questions on today's topic. Mark all doubts.
2:30 – 2:45	Short Break Break Walk, water, eyes off screen.

2:45 – 4:15	Aptitude — Topic-wise Study Aptitude Quant: Number system, %, ratio, time-work. Logical: syllogisms, seating arrangements. 1 topic per day.
4:15 – 4:30	Break Break Short rest.
4:30 – 6:15	DSA — Problem Set DSA / Coding Arrays / Strings / Linked Lists (Easy-Medium). Do at least 2 problems. Understand pattern, don't just copy.
6:15 – 7:00	End-of-Day Notes + Tracker Review Write 5 key points from today. Mark what to revisit. Log in notebook or Notion.

Day B — DSA Deep Dive + Project

Focus: DSA structured practice + Portfolio project building + Aptitude mock test

10:00 – 10:15	Warm-up Review Review Skim yesterday's GATE notes — 15 min only to stay warm on core subjects
10:15 – 12:30	DSA — Structured Practice DSA / Coding Follow roadmap: Arrays → Recursion → Sorting → Trees → Graphs. Solve 3–5 LeetCode Easy/Medium.
12:30 – 1:15	Lunch + Break Break Step away from screen completely.
1:15 – 2:30	Aptitude — Timed Mock Aptitude 20-question timed test (25 min). Analyse wrong answers for 30 min. Builds NQT and govt job readiness.
2:30 – 2:45	Break Break Short rest.

2:45 – 5:45	Project Work Project 3 hours uninterrupted. Build a real deployable project (full-stack CRUD, REST API, etc.). Directly builds job portfolio.
5:45 – 6:15	GATE — 1 Short Topic GATE Read one small GATE concept (e.g., one page of OS or CN). Keep GATE warm even on B days.
6:15 – 7:00	End-of-Day Log Review What did I build today? What DSA pattern did I learn? Log it.

Weekly Rhythm — Alternate A and B Days

Day	Type	Focus	Topics
Monday	Day A	GATE + Aptitude	GATE: OS / Algorithms Aptitude: Quantitative topic
Tuesday	Day B	DSA + Project	DSA: Arrays / Strings Project: Feature build
Wednesday	Day A	GATE + Aptitude	GATE: DBMS Aptitude: Logical reasoning
Thursday	Day B	DSA + Project	DSA: Recursion / Sorting Project: Continue
Friday	Day A	GATE + Aptitude	GATE: TOC / CN Aptitude: Timed mock
Saturday	Full Mock + Revision	Revision Day	Morning: GATE mock (2 hr) Afternoon: DSA contest or LeetCode Evening: Fix weak areas
Sunday	Light Day + Planning	Recovery	Revise week notes (1.5 hr) Plan next week Rest — consistency needs recovery

Job Assignment Rule — When a Company Sends a Web Dev Task

Deadline 3+ Days Away	Deadline 2 Days or Less
Do NOT touch regular study plan on Day 1. Read the assignment, plan what to build, then use your Project block (Day B 2:45–5:45) to work on it. GATE and DSA blocks continue as normal.	Declare a FLEX DAY. Pause Day A/B structure. Dedicate 10 AM – 5 PM to the assignment. Keep only the 5:45–7 PM slot for GATE revision so you don't go completely cold.

Job Applications: Dedicate 30 minutes every Sunday to apply. Batch-apply weekly — don't let daily job scrolling eat into study hours.
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3 Things to Do Today

1	2	3
Get a notebook and write what you study each day. This one habit will 2x your consistency.	Pick one GATE subject to start: OS is recommended — high weightage and directly useful in job interviews.	Do 2 LeetCode Easy problems tonight to start the DSA habit. Pattern: understand it, then solve it.

Remember: SC category GATE cutoff for NIT is 35–45 marks. Your 19 shows the base is there — structured coverage gets you there.